Isabel Thompson

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Urban researcher with experience in equity planning, transportation research, climate resilience, and public policy. Skilled in quantitative and qualitative analysis, stakeholder engagement, and turning complex information into clear, actionable insights. Passionate about creating positive social and environmental impact.

EDUCATION

University of Toronto, Major GPA: 3.85 — **Toronto, ON**
H.B.A. in Human Geography (Urban Planning focus), minors in GIS & Spanish — Jun 2026

- **Courses:** Social Research Methods, Environmental Planning, Public Health and Policy, Business Fundamentals
- **Awards/Achievements**: UToronto Excellence Award, Dean's List, LAS Undergraduate Research Day Presenter

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, *UofT Department of Geography & Planning* — Sep 2024 - Present

- Wrote a competitive research proposal securing $7,500+ in funding to assess green stormwater infrastructure and flood resilience in Washington, DC
- Independently led 20+ field investigations and combined findings with social vulnerability data to identify at-risk, underserved neighborhoods
- Conducted qualitative analysis of 50+ hours of stakeholder interviews and reviewed 30+ municipal plans and policies
- Shared findings with the public through interactive maps and a project website

Transportation Research Analyst, *Climate Action Partnership* — Aug 2025 - Jun 2026

- Benchmarked micromobility programs across North American cities, identifying strategies tied to safety, infrastructure, and mobility outcomes
- Built comparative frameworks evaluating governance, funding models, and equity in municipal transportation systems
- Co-authored a public report with actionable recommendations for Ontario municipalities and stakeholders

Policy & Program Intern, *Keystone Restituere Justice Center (KRJC)* — May 2024 - Aug 2024

- Tracked $25K+ in project budgets and managed schedules and deliverables, keeping projects on time and on budget
- Engaged correctional leadership, nonprofit partners, funders, and formerly incarcerated individuals in recidivism-prevention planning
- Produced executive briefings and public-facing materials that made complex issues accessible to diverse audiences

LEADERSHIP

Editor-in-Chief; Editor; Author, *Landmarks Journal of Geography* — Dec 2023 - Aug 2026

- Co-led a 12-member editorial team, reviewed 300 submissions, and managed peer-review-to-publication workflow
- Mentored authors on GIS, data-driven mapping, and research communication

Peer Mentor & Orientation Leader, *Innis College at the University of Toronto* — Jun 2023 - Aug 2024

- Mentored 20 first-year international students and co-led orientation events for 150+ incoming students

SKILLS & ACTIVITIES

- **Research & Analysis:** quantitative and qualitative analysis, policy and regulatory research, benchmarking, stakeholder engagement, interviewing, interview coding, proposal and report writing
- **Data & Tools:** Microsoft (PowerPoint, Word, Excel), Adobe (InDesign, Photoshop), AI (Gemini, Claude, ChatGPT), Python, HTML, GitHub, Datawrapper
- **GIS:** Esri (ArcGIS Pro/Online, Survey123, Field Maps, StoryMaps), QGIS, remote sensing, spatial statistics, cartography, census and demographic data analysis
- **Languages:** English, Spanish (proficient)
- **Activities:** Undergraduate Geography Society; Fort York Food Bank; Intramural Soccer & Ultimate Frisbee